

Realme Buds Clip

A comfortable open-ear buds under ₹6,000

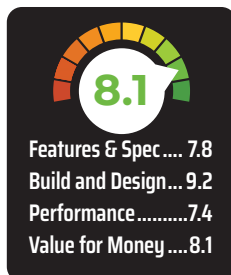
I've wanted to switch to open-ear earphones for a while. Not because they look trendy, but because my ears often ache. For a bit of context, I've been using in-ear buds for a long time. As a result, I've been having a subtle pain and pressure inside the ear canal, which has become a recurring issue. So, I recently started using Realme Buds Clip for its design that lets sound in without sealing the ear canal. The added benefit is ambient awareness, which matters on Indian streets, office floors, and crammed homes. But, this open-ear design comes with clear trade-offs, don't expect ANC or isolation here. Pointing out that as a flaw isn't the purpose of this review. Instead, this piece tells you the practicality of the Buds Clip in everyday life. Let's dive in.

LIGHTWEIGHT BUILD

The first thing you notice is how 'un-earbud-like' the Realme Buds Clip feel. Quite literally, there's no silicone tip inside your ear. Instead, the Buds Clip sit around the concha and hooks gently, leaving your ear open to the world and your senses unobstructed. They look like one of those cuff earrings.

Wearing the Buds Clip with music on, you can still hear the surroundings a bit. And if you turn off the music, you can walk comfortably on a busy road without feeling its presence on the ear. An in-ear earphone, however light it may be, still muffles what you hear. You don't have that problem here.

Talking of lightness, this thing is only 5.3 grams. You forget you're wearing them right away. You can wear them for hours at once. It doesn't fall off with



head jerks, or while pulling out a jacket or sweater you are wearing. They stay grippy without feeling tight or pinching. The comfort is genuinely pleasant!

Now, its appearance or your liking for it could depend on your style. Some can pull it off or won't mind what others think. People notice it, for the novel design and out of curiosity, they may sometimes even ask what it is. To some, you may look funny also. But like I said, some don't mind, or better, they make it work. The Buds Clip come in two colours: Titanium Black and Titanium Gold. Personally, I'm glad to have received the black colour for this review, because pulling off that gold finish isn't my cup of tea.

One personal qualm with the Realme Buds Clip is that loud street traffic and engine hum will still be audible, and can be annoying to hear alongside rock or anything loud and harsh you are already

hearing. Agreed, that's by design, but it is still something you should know. On the plus side, the buds support IP55 dust and water resistance, akin to the Buds Air 8, which makes them suitable for heavy workouts and outdoor use.

STABLE CONNECTION

Pairing the Realme Buds Clip to my phone via Bluetooth worked fine. But the unit we got wasn't connecting to the Realme Link app on the Play Store. Instead, it was working with the Chinese version of the app. The UI and options are mostly like the Realme Buds Air 8. You get options like EQ mode with 4 presets and a custom creation option, spatial audio, AI Translate, Game Mode, dual-device connection (which you have to enable), and Touch Control edits.

The controls are simple and responsive. But the unique form factor needs some getting used to. Some hits and trials to learn where to tap to activate touch controls. The thick part of the buds is where you have to tap.

The connection was stable, provided there were no hindrances like closed doors. Call quality was also decent. Again, because of the design, some leakage happens, and people can hear what you are listening to if they are close to you.

OPEN, AIRY, AND SAFE SOUND

The sound signature matches the design philosophy: open, airy, and without deep isolation. I was listening in Clear Bass mode at 100% volume on my Galaxy S23 with Bass Boost+ enabled. Even then, loudness remains modest. Positioning the buds slightly differently can help, but they never get truly loud. For context, 80% volume on the Realme Buds Air 8 is louder than 100% volume on the Buds Clip. This is safe from an ear-health perspective.

Listening to Hotel California by The Eagles felt like the music was playing around me, not inside my head. Compared to the Buds Air 8, the Buds Clip has less body and presence. Instruments sound softer and less defined.